

RentCast Test Query Design: Las Cruces NM

GROUP A: /properties Endpoint — saleDateRange Variants (PRIMARY)

This endpoint is the primary choice for FirstKnock.online as it guarantees confirmed closed transactions based on official county records ^[1].

Exact Test URLs

ZIP Code 88001:

- **A1 (90-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=90`
- **A2 (180-day, RECOMMENDED):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=180`
- **A3 (270-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=270`
- **A4 (365-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=365`

ZIP Code 88005:

- **A1 (90-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88005&saleDateRange=90`
- **A2 (180-day, RECOMMENDED):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88005&saleDateRange=180`
- **A3 (270-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88005&saleDateRange=270`
- **A4 (365-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88005&saleDateRange=365`

ZIP Code 88012:

- **A1 (90-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88012&saleDateRange=90`
- **A2 (180-day, RECOMMENDED):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88012&saleDateRange=180`
- **A3 (270-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88012&saleDateRange=270`
- **A4 (365-day):**
`https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88012&saleDateRange=365`

Latitude/Longitude + Radius Variants (Las Cruces Center):

- **A5 (8-mile radius):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?latitude=32.3199&longitude=-106.7637&radius=8&saleDateRange=180
```

- **A6 (12-mile radius):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?latitude=32.3199&longitude=-106.7637&radius=12&saleDateRange=180
```

Query Specifications

1. **HTTP Header Needed:** X-Api-Key: `YOUR_API_KEY`
2. **Field Confirming SOLD:** The presence of the `lastSaleDate` and `lastSalePrice` fields confirms an official deed transfer occurred ^[1].
3. **Date Field to Inspect:** Inspect the `lastSaleDate` field ^[1]. The value should be an ISO **8601** date falling within the requested `saleDateRange` (e.g., within the last **90, 180, 270, or 365** days).
4. **Red Flags (Not a Confirmed Sale):** If `lastSaleDate` is missing, null, or falls outside your requested timeframe, the record is invalid for your current sold-home targeting.

GROUP B: /listings/sale Endpoint — status and daysOld Variants (COMPARISON/CONTROL)

This endpoint pulls from MLS data. It is useful for real-time market movement but contains critical flaws for identifying strictly sold properties ^[1].

Exact Test URLs

(Using ZIP 88001 as the control area)

- **B1 (Active, 90 days old):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/listings/sale?zipCode=88001&status=Active&daysOld=90
```

- **B2 (Inactive, 90 days old):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/listings/sale?zipCode=88001&status=Inactive&daysOld=90
```

- **B3 (Inactive, 180 days old):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/listings/sale?zipCode=88001&status=Inactive&daysOld=180
```

- **B4 (Test Invalid 'Sold' Status):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/listings/sale?zipCode=88001&status=Sold&daysOld=90
```

- **B5 (Test Combined Statuses):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/listings/sale?zipCode=88001&status=Sold,Inactive&daysOld=90
```

Query Specifications

1. **HTTP Header Needed:** X-Api-Key: `YOUR_API_KEY`
2. **Field Confirming SOLD:** None. There is no way to confirm a property successfully sold using this endpoint alone ^[1]. The `Inactive` status is a catch-all that includes sold, expired, e

withdrawn, and cancelled listings^[1]. Furthermore, queries B4 and B5 will likely fail or ignore the “Sold” parameter because the API **ONLY** accepts `Active` or `Inactive`^[1].

3. **Date Field to Inspect:** `listedDate` : This is what `daysOld` actually filters (days since it hit the market)^[1]. Expect this date to be within the last **90** or **180** days. `removedDate` : The date the property came off the market^[1].
4. **Red Flags (Not a Confirmed Sale):** Any result from this endpoint is a red flag if used in isolation for a “sold” campaign. An `Inactive` status simply means it is off the market^[1].

GROUP C: Pagination Queries

The API returns a maximum of **500** records per response^[1]. Pagination is required for larger datasets.

Exact Test URLs

(Using the recommended 180-day range for ZIP 88001)

- **C1 (Page 1):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=180&limit=500&offset=0
```

- **C2 (Page 2):**

```
https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=180&limit=500&offset=500
```

Query Specifications

1. **HTTP Header Needed:** `X-Api-Key: YOUR_API_KEY`
2. **C3: How to detect when all pages are exhausted:** You have reached the end of the dataset when the number of objects returned in the JSON array is less than your `limit` parameter (less than **500**), or when the API returns an entirely empty array `[]`.

Explaining the 7-11 vs 215 Result Discrepancy

The massive difference between the **7-11** results from the `/properties` endpoint and the **215** results from the `/listings/sale` endpoint is caused by fundamentally different data sources and filtering logic^[1].

*Which count is more accurate for “truly sold” homes? The **7-11** count from the `/properties` endpoint is the **ONLY** accurate representation of confirmed, closed transactions^[1].*

Here is exactly why the discrepancy exists:

- **The County Recording Lag (Why `/properties` is low):** The `/properties` endpoint relies on official county deed and tax records^[1]. When a home closes, it typically takes **30** to

90 days for the county clerk to officially record the deed ^[1]. Therefore, a `saleDateRange=90` query is looking at a delayed snapshot of the market and will miss homes that closed very recently but haven't been digitized by the county yet ^[1].

- **The “Inactive” Catch-All (Why `/listings/sale` is high):** The `/listings/sale` endpoint pulls real-time MLS data, but it only has two statuses: `Active` and `Inactiv` ^[1]. The **215** results represent *every single home* taken off the market, which includes a massive amount of expired, withdrawn, and cancelled listings, not just successful sales ^[1].
- **The `daysOld` Trap:** On the listings endpoint, `daysOld=90` measures days since the property was **listed**, not sold ^[1]. This means the **215** results captured homes that hit the market recently and failed quickly, while completely missing homes that successfully sold last week but were originally listed **100+** days ago ^[1].

References

- [1] "RentCast API Documentation Extractor".